



IN THE SCHOOLROOM



The blackboard was double-sided. It was on wheels so it could be moved easily.



Until 1870, children in England did not have to go to school. Children from rich families went to school, but poor families could not afford to pay for education. Poor children had to go to work to help their parents. After 1870, the government made school places available to young children for a very small fee. By 1902, education was free and every child between five and thirteen years old had to attend school.

At school, children were taught reading, writing, arithmetic, and religion. The children sat at their desks, chanting spellings and tables over and over again, and copying words onto slates. At other times they did some geography and history, drawing, singing, and physical exercise. Discipline was very strict and children were beaten if they made mistakes in their work.

The globe of the world was used to teach geography to the children.

A wooden hoop used for playing.

Playtime

When they were not in school, children amused themselves with outdoor games like the ones played today—marbles, skipping, hopscotch, and football. Hoops were popular, too—they were rolled along the ground, thrown in the air, or whirled around the body.



China inkwells in a tray were filled and given out to the older children by a monitor. The children wrote with pen and ink in a special copybook.

The ink to fill the inkwells was kept in a special container that looked like a small watering can.

